

TRUEVOW

RETAINER

Product Architecture and Build Specification

Version 1.0 | July 29, 2026

Implementation-ready greenfield specification
California plaintiff personal-injury contingency engagement workflow

The firm exercises legal authority. TrueVow executes the authorized workflow. Every material action remains attributable, policy-versioned and auditable.

CONFIDENTIAL - PRODUCT / ENGINEERING REFERENCE

Document control and source-of-truth order

| Priority | Source | What it controls |

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| 1 | TrueVow Ontology Registry | Canonical IDs, authority classes, actors, entities, states, events, invariants, metrics, envelope and transition contract |

| 2 | Versioned shared contracts package / SaaS Admin reference data | Executable shared schemas, policy and authority reference data |

| 3 | This RETAINER specification and companion registries | Product behavior, product extensions, API/data/workflow contracts |

| 4 | Implementation code | Must conform to the sources above; code does not redefine the ontology |

| 5 | UI labels and projections | May vary without changing canonical meaning |

When sources conflict, implementation must fail CI until the contract is normalized. No repository may silently choose its own interpretation.

Executive decisions

- RETAINER is the missing greenfield product; INTAKE, SaaS Admin, TRACE, and SETTLE continue their ontology refactors independently.
- RETAINER owns Firm-Approved Representation -> Completed Engagement and Activation Conditions. It does not decide representation.
- SaaS Admin remains authoritative for tenants, users, roles, attorney verification, jurisdiction profiles, policies, template approvals, entitlements, and integration settings.
- RETAINER integrates with other products through versioned commands/events/APIs; it never reads or writes another product database.
- The shared WorkflowRuntime loads RETAINER registries; RETAINER does not fork a second state-machine framework.
- California v1 requires named-attorney representation approval, conflict clearance, legal-question handling, and matter activation authority.
- No AI component may appear in the authority path. Optional AI assistance remains disabled in v1 except separately governed source-linked drafts for firm review.
- DocuSeal may be the initial e-sign adapter, but RETAINER remains provider-neutral.
- Redis may support locks, rate limits, and queues; canonical state remains in PostgreSQL/event storage.
- All material actions are tenant-scoped, policy-versioned, authority-gated, idempotent, and auditable.

Immediate contract normalization gate

The deployed reports contain three event-envelope counts: 15, 17, and 18. The ontology YAML contains 17 listed required fields while its rules require schema versioning. RETAINER v1 therefore requires an 18-field EventEnvelope v1.0.1: the 17 ontology fields plus schema_version. The ontology/contracts package must be patched before cross-repository release.

| Contract issue | Normative RETAINER decision | Required action |

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| Event envelope | 18 required fields including schema_version | Publish JSON Schema; run contract tests in every repository |

| Authority classes | Six classes: SYS_ADMIN, FIRM_POLICY, STAFF_AUTH, ATTY_AUTH, CLIENT_AUTH, PROHIBITED | Do not collapse STAFF_AUTH into FIRM_POLICY |

| Event counts | Ontology events marked canonical; seeded/product events marked extension | Add canonical flag, owner and schema version |

| Runtime duplication | Shared contracts centralized; runtime implementations may remain local | Publish versioned truevow-contracts package |

| Matter creation ownership | Canonical activation command/API owns creation; RETAINER cannot insert directly | Name service owner and lock contract |

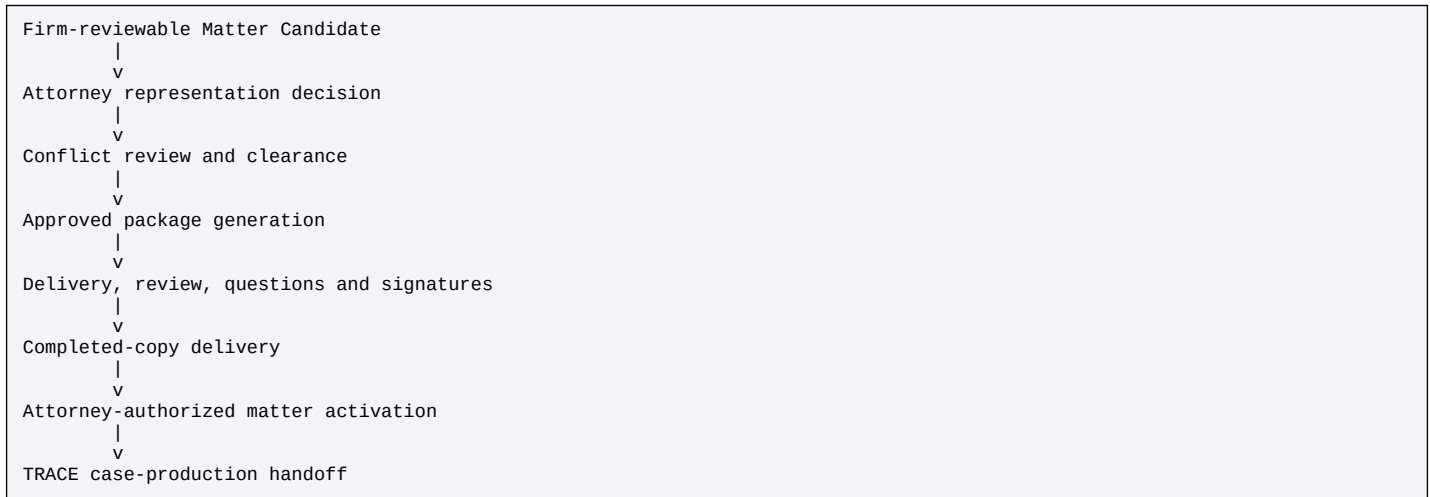
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1. Product Mandate and Boundaries

1.1 Product statement

RETAINER turns a firm-approved prospective engagement into a completed, evidence-backed engagement workflow and an authorized matter activation. It automates administrative execution after the law firm supplies the required authority.



1.2 Owned transition

| Input business state | Output business state | Success event |

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| Firm-approved representation pending engagement conditions | Completed engagement and activated Matter | matter.activated |

1.3 In scope for California v1

- Direct tenant-firm prospects supplied by INTAKE or authorized staff entry.
- California plaintiff personal-injury contingency agreements using tenant-attorney-approved templates.
- Attorney representation decision and responsible-attorney assignment.
- Deterministic tenant-scoped conflict search plus named-attorney clearance/hold.
- Template resolution, merge validation, package generation, preview, locking and delivery.
- Electronic transaction consent, secure portal review, questions, signatures and completed-copy delivery.
- Firm-configured email reminders; SMS remains separately gated by consent and configuration.
- Activation checklist, named-attorney activation authorization, canonical Matter activation and TRACE handoff.
- Complete audit, export, retention, legal hold and reconciliation support.

1.4 Explicitly out of scope

- TrueVow deciding whether to accept or reject representation.
- Automatic conflict clearance, waiver, or legal analysis.
- AI-generated legal explanations, fee negotiation, clause drafting or authority decisions.
- A cross-firm lead marketplace or TrueVow lawyer-referral network.
- Medical-malpractice, workers-compensation, hourly, flat-fee, joint-representation or translated-authoritative agreements in v1.
- Percentage-of-fee, percentage-of-recovery, or per-signed-client commercial pricing.
- Direct database coupling to INTAKE, SaaS Admin, TRACE or SETTLE.
- Case production, medical records, demand drafting, settlement decision, liens or disbursement.

1.5 Product principles

22. Authority before automation.
23. Business state before UI status.
24. Policy over hard-coded tenant behavior.
25. Immutable evidence over mutable logs.
26. Deterministic execution in the authority path.
27. Fail closed when authority, policy, tenant, document, consent or jurisdiction evidence is missing.
28. One canonical record owner; projections are rebuildable.
29. Provider-neutral adapters.
30. No cross-tenant data use.
31. Every exception becomes an explicit review task.

2. Current Platform Baseline

2.1 Deployed foundation supplied to RETAINER

Foundation	Reported implementation	RETAINER dependency
Ontology reference data	Authority actions, event catalog, state models, invariants, actors and entities seeded/queryable	Import IDs and validate startup compatibility
Authority Gate	AUTH-001 through AUTH-020 plus platform extensions; fail closed	Use for every reserved/material command
WorkflowRuntime	Shared registry-driven deterministic runtime	Load RETAINER state/transition/event registries
Event Store / Audit Store	Append-only, tenant-scoped, idempotent business events	Emit normalized envelope; preserve replayability
Policy Registry	Versioned firm policies and jurisdiction profiles	Resolve immutable snapshots per action
Consent Ledger	Append-only consent lifecycle	Electronic delivery, e-sign, SMS and revocation
Document Service	Immutable versions, SHA-256 hashes and signature evidence	Generate/lock/deliver package documents
Communication Service	Multi-channel send/receive, evidence and reminders	Transactional engagement communications
Integration Hub	Tenant-scoped integrations and sync tracking	E-sign, mail/SMS, matter activation, TRACE handoff
Tenant & Identity Core	Tenant isolation, role checks, attorney verification	Authentication and authorization source

2.2 Foundation compatibility checks at startup

- Ontology registry version is supported.
- All six authority classes exist.
- Required canonical entities and events exist.
- EventEnvelope schema hash matches the shared package.
- WorkflowRuntime transition contract version is compatible.
- SaaS Admin reports effective jurisdiction and tenant-policy versions.
- Document, communication, consent, audit and integration adapters pass health checks.

2.3 RETAINER-owned versus shared records

Record/capability	Canonical owner	RETAINER behavior
Tenant, User, Role, Attorney verification	SaaS Admin / Shared Platform	Read via contract; cache as projection only
Matter Candidate and intake facts	INTAKE	Consume immutable handoff; do not mutate
Representation Decision	RETAINER	Create/version/emit events
Conflict Search/Candidate/Review	RETAINER	Create/version/emit events
Template approval and jurisdiction policy	SaaS Admin / Shared Platform	Resolve approved version
Engagement Workflow/Package/Question/Activation Checklist	RETAINER	Canonical aggregate ownership
Document Version, Communication, Consent, Audit Event	Shared Platform	Call shared service; store references
Matter and Responsible Attorney Assignment	Canonical Matter owner / Shared Business Core	Request activation; receive result
TRACE case-production context	TRACE	Emit/forward matter.activated manifest
SETTLE records	SETTLE	No direct v1 dependency

3. Users, Authority and Permissions

3.1 Primary user roles

Role	Primary RETAINER responsibilities	Reserved boundary
Intake Coordinator / Staff	Prepare review, complete facts, initiate searches, prepare package, follow up	Cannot approve representation or clear conflict
Responsible Attorney	Approve/decline representation, define scope, clear/hold conflicts, answer legal questions, authorize activation	Cannot delegate reserved authority to software
Firm Administrator	Configure users, templates, policies, channels, integrations, entitlements	Administrative role does not create licensure
Prospective Client	Consent, review, ask questions, sign/decline, control communication choices	Cannot authorize firm legal judgment
Authorized Representative	Act within verified scope for another person	Authority never inferred solely from relationship
TrueVow Support	Technical assistance under just-in-time controlled access	No legal advice; no unrestricted tenant access
Automation / AI Actor	Execute deterministic administrative actions or produce nonauthoritative drafts/signals	Cannot self-authorize or exercise professional/client authority

3.2 Normative authority classes

Class	Meaning	RETAINER examples
SYS_ADMIN	Administrative execution allowed by platform design.	Hashing, objective preflight, event recording, completed-copy delivery after gates
FIRM_POLICY	Execution allowed only under an effective tenant-approved policy.	Template resolution, delivery under approved policy, reminder cadence
STAFF_AUTH	Named authorized staff member must decide or approve.	Prepare review, initiate search, correct administrative facts
ATTY_AUTH	Licensed/authorized attorney must decide or approve.	Approve representation, clear conflict, answer legal questions, authorize activation
CLIENT_AUTH	Client or verified representative must decide or consent.	Electronic consent, signature, decline, communication revocation
PROHIBITED	TrueVow must not perform this action.	Self-approval, automatic case acceptance, AI legal explanation, cross-tenant use

3.3 Permission model

Authorization is the intersection of authenticated identity, active tenant membership, role assignment, authority class, action registry, jurisdiction profile, tenant policy, aggregate state, required evidence and feature entitlement. A role name alone is never sufficient.


```

allow = identity_valid
      AND tenant_active
      AND membership_active
      AND action_registered
      AND authority_satisfied
      AND jurisdiction_effective
      AND policy_effective
      AND state_allows_command
      AND evidence_complete
      AND entitlement_enabled

otherwise: fail_closed + audit denial

```

3.4 Core action matrix

Action	Staff	Attorney	Client	Platform	AI
Prepare candidate review	Allowed	Allowed	-	Assist	Draft only
Approve/decline representation	No	Required	-	Record only	Prohibited
Run conflict search	Allowed by policy	Allowed	-	Execute	No authority
Clear/hold conflict	No	Required	Consent only if separately needed	Record only	Prohibited
Resolve approved template	Prepare	Approve policy/template	-	Execute	Prohibited in v1
Explain legal term	No	Required	Ask/receive	Route only	Prohibited
Sign client agreement	No	-	Required	Capture	Prohibited
Send reminders	Configure/monitor	Configure/monitor	May revoke	Execute	No discretion
Authorize activation	Prepare checklist	Required in CA v1	-	Validate/execute	Prohibited

4. Customer and Staff Journeys

4.1 Happy path

32. INTAKE emits a versioned candidate handoff.
33. Staff reviews candidate facts and assigns attorney review.
34. Attorney approves representation for defined scope.
35. RETAINER performs tenant-scoped conflict search.
36. Attorney clears conflict or records approved exception.
37. Policy Registry resolves the approved California contingency template.
38. Document Service generates and locks the package after preflight.
39. Firm policy authorizes delivery.
40. Prospect consents to electronic transaction and receives a retainable package.
41. Prospect reviews; logistical questions are handled; legal questions route to the attorney.
42. Required client and firm signatures are captured with evidence.
43. Fully executed duplicate copy is delivered.
44. Activation checklist passes; attorney authorizes activation.
45. Canonical Matter owner activates idempotently and emits matter.activated.
46. TRACE consumes the event and creates its source-linked case-production context.

4.2 Conflict-hold path

```
ATTORNEY_APPROVAL_RECORDED
-> CONFLICT_REVIEW_PENDING
-> CONFLICT_HOLD
-> attorney review / waiver process outside automation
-> either PACKAGE_PREPARATION or DECLINED_OR_EXPIRED
```

4.3 Legal-question path

```
CLIENT_REVIEW
-> engagement.question_received
-> classification: logistical | legal_or_uncertain
-> logistical: approved static/process response
-> legal_or_uncertain: engagement.question_escalated + attorney work item
-> attributable attorney response
-> return to CLIENT_REVIEW / SIGNATURE_PENDING
```

4.4 Expiration, decline and withdrawal

- Firm-policy expiration stops reminders, preserves package/evidence, and records engagement.expired.
- Client decline records attributable CLIENT_AUTH and suppresses further engagement reminders.
- Attorney withdrawal before activation records authority and terminates the workflow.
- Reissue always creates a new package/workflow version after current policy/template checks; stale signed bytes are never reused.

4.5 Recovery and reconciliation journey

- Provider callbacks are idempotent and correlated to ceremony/delivery IDs.
- Unknown matter-activation outcomes enter reconciliation; RETAINER never infers success from timeout.
- Conflicting duplicate events are quarantined and create a security/operations work item.
- Projection rebuild is supported from immutable events and referenced shared records.

5. Functional Scope and Requirements

This specification defines **91 testable requirements**. P0 items are required for pilot; P1 items may be completed during controlled pilot hardening but their architecture must be supported from the start.

5.1 INTAKE handoff

ID	Requirement	Normative statement	Priority	Authority	Verification
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RET-INT-001	Consume candidate handoff	The system shall consume a versioned Matter Candidate handoff through an authenticated contract, never by reading INTAKE database tables.	P0	SYS_ADMIN	Contract + integration test
RET-INT-002	Idempotent candidate import	The same candidate handoff event shall produce one RETAINER candidate projection and no duplicate workflow.	P0	SYS_ADMIN	Duplicate-event test
RET-INT-003	Preserve source references	Imported facts shall retain source entity IDs, source event IDs, source versions, and provenance links.	P0	SYS_ADMIN	Data lineage test
RET-INT-004	No source mutation	RETAINER shall not update, delete, or reinterpret authoritative INTAKE records.	P0	PROHIBITED	Permission + contract test
RET-INT-005	Tenant validation	The candidate tenant shall be active or trial and shall match the authenticated tenant context.	P0	SYS_ADMIN	Negative security test
RET-INT-006	Candidate version conflict	A conflicting candidate version shall create a discrepancy work item instead of silently overwriting the current projection.	P0	FIRM_POLICY	Version-conflict test
RET-INT-007	Incomplete candidate routing	Missing required administrative data shall create a completion task and shall not create attorney approval.	P0	FIRM_POLICY	State + authority test
RET-INT-008	Candidate withdrawal	A withdrawn or suppressed candidate shall stop RETAINER outreach and move any active workflow to a governed terminal path.	P0	CLIENT_AUTH / FIRM_POLICY	E2E withdrawal test

5.2 Representation decision

ID	Requirement	Normative statement	Priority	Authority	Verification
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RET-REP-001	Attorney-attributable decision	Acceptance, decline, or deferral shall identify the named attorney, scope, timestamp, authority record, and decision version.	P0	ATTY_AUTH	Authority + audit test
RET-REP-002	No automated acceptance	No score, AI output, qualification status, timer, or workflow completion shall create representation approval.	P0	PROHIBITED	Prohibited transition test
RET-REP-003	Staff preparation only	Authorized staff may prepare a review record but may not emit the attorney approval event.	P0	STAFF_AUTH	Role matrix test
RET-REP-004	Decision scope required	Approval shall define practice area, matter type, represented parties, excluded parties, and intended scope sufficient for template resolution.	P0	ATTY_AUTH	Validation test
RET-REP-005	Responsible attorney assignment	An approved workflow shall identify at least one responsible attorney before activation.	P0	ATTY_AUTH	Invariant test
RET-REP-006	Decline workflow	An attorney decline shall create an immutable decision record and may authorize a firm-approved nonengagement communication.	P0	ATTY_AUTH / FIRM_POLICY	E2E decline test
RET-REP-007	Deferral workflow	A deferred decision shall retain the candidate in a review state with a due date, reason category, and assigned owner.	P1	ATTY_AUTH	Timer/escalation test

| RET-REP-008 | Decision supersession | A later decision shall supersede rather than mutate the earlier decision and shall preserve the full history. | P0 | ATTY_AUTH | Append-only test |

5.3 Conflict workflow

| ID | Requirement | Normative statement | Priority | Authority | Verification |

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| RET-CON-001 | Deterministic conflict search | The system shall run tenant-scoped deterministic searches over configured party and relationship sources. | P0 | FIRM_POLICY | Search-scope test |

| RET-CON-002 | Search evidence | Every conflict search shall record inputs, normalized forms, sources searched, algorithm version, and completion timestamp. | P0 | FIRM_POLICY | Audit completeness test |

| RET-CON-003 | Candidate not clearance | A possible match or no-match result shall never be represented as attorney conflict clearance. | P0 | PROHIBITED | Copy + state test |

| RET-CON-004 | Attorney clearance | Conflict clearance, waiver, or hold resolution shall be attributable to a named attorney. | P0 | ATTY_AUTH | Authority test |

| RET-CON-005 | Conflict hold | A material unresolved conflict candidate shall block package preparation and delivery. | P0 | ATTY_AUTH | Fail-closed test |

| RET-CON-006 | Party-change invalidation | Adding or materially changing a party shall invalidate current conflict clearance and require a new search or attorney confirmation. | P0 | FIRM_POLICY / ATTY_AUTH | Invalidation test |

| RET-CON-007 | Search scope configuration | SaaS Admin shall define the systems and datasets included in the tenant conflict search profile. | P1 | FIRM_POLICY | Configuration contract test |

| RET-CON-008 | Manual conflict record | The product shall support manual review notes, decision rationale references, and uploaded supporting records without forcing disclosure to the client portal. | P1 | ATTY_AUTH | Permission test |

| RET-CON-009 | No cross-tenant conflict pool | Conflict data shall never be pooled or searched across unrelated tenants. | P0 | PROHIBITED | Cross-tenant penetration test |

| RET-CON-010 | Reopen after hold | A conflict hold may be released only through a new attorney-attributable decision that identifies the cleared scope or approved exception. | P0 | ATTY_AUTH | Transition test |

5.4 Templates and packages

| ID | Requirement | Normative statement | Priority | Authority | Verification |

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| RET-TPL-001 | Approved template only | The system shall generate engagement documents only from an effective tenant-attorney-approved template. | P0 | FIRM_POLICY | Policy resolution test |

| RET-TPL-002 | California v1 scope | The initial jurisdiction module shall support California plaintiff personal-injury contingency agreements and explicitly exclude medical malpractice, workers compensation, hourly, and flat-fee workflows. | P0 | FIRM_POLICY | Feature-flag test |

| RET-TPL-003 | Version-locked template | Template text, approval, effective period, merge schema, jurisdiction, matter type, and hash shall be immutable for a released version. | P0 | ATTY_AUTH | Mutation test |

| RET-TPL-004 | Deterministic template mapping | Template selection shall use an approved mapping of jurisdiction, practice area, fee type, and firm policy. | P0 | FIRM_POLICY | Decision-table test |

| RET-TPL-005 | No AI clause selection | AI shall not select, create, rewrite, remove, or reorder substantive legal clauses in v1. | P0 | PROHIBITED | Prohibited-action test |

| RET-TPL-006 | Merge-field provenance | Every populated merge field shall record its source, validation status, and value version. | P0 | SYS_ADMIN | Provenance test |

| RET-TPL-007 | Required-field preflight | Package generation shall fail closed when required merge fields, disclosures, approvals, or template mappings are absent. | P0 | FIRM_POLICY | Negative preflight test |

| RET-TPL-008 | Document immutability | Every generated, delivered, or signed document version shall have a stable document ID, version ID, SHA-256 hash, and immutable content. | P0 | SYS_ADMIN | Hash + mutation test |

| RET-TPL-009 | Package manifest | An Engagement Package shall contain a manifest of documents, disclosures, signer requirements, delivery rules, and hashes. | P0 | FIRM_POLICY | Manifest validation test |

| RET-TPL-010 | Attorney revision flow | Substantive edits shall create a draft version, diff, named attorney approval, and new effective version; they shall never alter a delivered package. | P1 | ATTY_AUTH | Versioning E2E test |

| RET-TPL-011 | Preview parity | The attorney preview shall render the exact bytes that will be delivered and signed. | P0 | FIRM_POLICY | Byte/hash parity test |

| RET-TPL-012 | Translation exclusion | Authoritative translated legal agreements shall remain disabled until a separately approved translation workflow exists. | P1 | PROHIBITED | Feature flag test |

5.5 Client portal and questions

| ID | Requirement | Normative statement | Priority | Authority | Verification |

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| RET-PRT-001 | Secure portal access | The client portal shall use tenant-branded, time-bounded, revocable access with step-up verification for sensitive actions. | P0 | CLIENT_AUTH | Security E2E test |

| RET-PRT-002 | Firm identity | The portal shall identify the tenant law firm as the legal-services provider and TrueVow as technology where appropriate. | P0 | FIRM_POLICY | Content snapshot test |

| RET-PRT-003 | Electronic consent | Before electronic delivery/signature, the portal shall capture affirmative, attributable consent and preserve revocation history. | P0 | CLIENT_AUTH | Consent lifecycle test |

| RET-PRT-004 | Retainable documents | Delivered records shall be downloadable or otherwise retainable by the recipient. | P0 | SYS_ADMIN | Download test |

| RET-PRT-005 | Client review state | Opening the package may move the experience projection to review but shall not count as consent, signature, or legal acceptance. | P0 | CLIENT_AUTH | State semantics test |

| RET-PRT-006 | Logistical help only | Approved portal help may explain access, signing, upload, and scheduling; legal interpretation shall route to the firm. | P0 | FIRM_POLICY | Content + escalation test |

| RET-PRT-007 | Question capture | The client may submit a question linked to the package, document, page, or clause without changing the document state. | P1 | CLIENT_AUTH | Portal E2E test |

| RET-PRT-008 | Attorney response attribution | Responses to legal questions shall identify the responding firm actor and shall not be generated as TrueVow legal advice. | P0 | ATTY_AUTH | Authority test |

| RET-PRT-009 | Alternative channel | A firm-approved non-electronic or assisted process shall be available when electronic consent is declined or accessibility assistance is requested. | P1 | FIRM_POLICY | Fallback workflow test |

| RET-PRT-010 | Client stop/decline | The client may decline the package or request no further automated reminders, and the system shall record and honor that choice. | P0 | CLIENT_AUTH | Suppression test |

5.6 Signatures

| ID | Requirement | Normative statement | Priority | Authority | Verification |

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| RET-SIG-001 | Signature ceremony | Each signing session shall bind a signer, authority/capacity, document version, authentication context, and intent event. | P0 | CLIENT_AUTH / ATTY_AUTH | Evidence package test |

| RET-SIG-002 | Client signature authority | The platform shall never sign for the client; representative capacity shall be explicitly verified where applicable. | P0 | PROHIBITED | Prohibited-action test |

| RET-SIG-003 | Firm signatory authority | A firm signature shall require a valid attorney or authorized firm-signatory role and an attributable signing action. | P0 | ATTY_AUTH | Role + evidence test |

| RET-SIG-004 | Evidence package | Signature evidence shall include signer identity, intent, authentication method, timestamp, IP/device evidence where enabled, document hash, provider reference, and ceremony ID. | P0 | CLIENT_AUTH / ATTY_AUTH | Schema validation test |

| RET-SIG-005 | No image-only evidence | A pasted signature image or typed name shall not be the sole evidence of execution. | P0 | PROHIBITED | Negative evidence test |

| RET-SIG-006 | Required signer completion | The package shall become fully executed only when every required signer and acknowledgment requirement for the locked manifest is complete. | P0 | SYS_ADMIN | Transition guard test |

| RET-SIG-007 | Signature invalidation | An invalidated signature shall preserve the original evidence, record the reason and authority, and block execution until corrected. | P0 | FIRM_POLICY / ATTY_AUTH | Invalidation E2E test |

| RET-SIG-008 | Signed-version immutability | A signed document shall never be edited in place; amendments shall use a new package or formal amendment workflow. | P0 | PROHIBITED | Mutation test |

| RET-SIG-009 | Completed-copy delivery | The system shall deliver the fully executed duplicate copy and preserve delivery evidence before activation. | P0 | SYS_ADMIN | Delivery gate test |

| RET-SIG-010 | Provider abstraction | DocuSeal may be the initial adapter, but RETAINER domain records shall remain provider-neutral and portable. | P1 | FIRM_POLICY | Adapter contract test |

5.7 Communications and reminders

| ID | Requirement | Normative statement | Priority | Authority | Verification |

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| RET-COM-001 | Transactional email | The system shall send firm-branded transactional emails through the shared Communication Service using approved templates and sender identity. | P0 | FIRM_POLICY | Template + delivery test |

| RET-COM-002 | Consent-aware SMS | SMS reminders shall remain feature-gated and shall execute only with effective channel consent, opt-out handling, and tenant policy. | P1 | FIRM_POLICY / CLIENT_AUTH | Consent/suppression test |

| RET-COM-003 | No automated voice in v1 | Automated reminder calls shall be disabled in California v1 unless separately approved and configured. | P1 | PROHIBITED | Feature flag test |

| RET-COM-004 | Reminder cadence | Reminder timing, maximum attempts, quiet hours, expiration, and escalation shall come from an immutable tenant policy snapshot. | P0 | FIRM_POLICY | Timer policy test |

| RET-COM-005 | Stop on revocation | Relevant automated communication shall stop after revocation, decline, withdrawal, expiration, or suppression. | P0 | CLIENT_AUTH / FIRM_POLICY | Suppression race test |

| RET-COM-006 | Delivery evidence | Every outbound communication shall preserve sender, recipient, channel, content version, policy version, attempt, provider ID, and result. | P0 | SYS_ADMIN | Audit completeness test |

| RET-COM-007 | Escalate failures | Repeated delivery failure or unanswered legal question shall create a human work item with SLA and owner. | P1 | FIRM_POLICY | Escalation test |

| RET-COM-008 | No marketing contamination | Engagement communications shall not include unrelated marketing content or restart suppressed nurture sequences. | P0 | PROHIBITED | Content policy test |

5.8 Activation and TRACE handoff

| ID | Requirement | Normative statement | Priority | Authority | Verification |

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| RET-ACT-001 | Activation checklist | Activation shall evaluate a versioned checklist containing representation, conflict, attorney, agreement, delivery, consent, signature, jurisdiction, tenant, and firm-defined conditions. | P0 | FIRM_POLICY | Checklist contract test |

| RET-ACT-002 | Named attorney activation | California v1 shall require a named-attorney activation authorization even after objective checks pass. | P0 | ATTY_AUTH | Authority test |

| RET-ACT-003 | No candidate shortcut | A Matter Candidate shall never become a Matter directly from qualification, document generation, or signature completion. | P0 | PROHIBITED | Prohibited transition test |

| RET-ACT-004 | Command, not database insert | RETAINER shall request matter creation through the canonical activation command/API and shall not write another product database. | P0 | SYS_ADMIN | Architecture test |

| RET-ACT-005 | Idempotent activation | Repeated activation commands with the same idempotency key and evidence set shall return the same result without duplicate Matters. | P0 | SYS_ADMIN | Retry test |

| RET-ACT-006 | Activation evidence manifest | The activation command shall include references to representation decision, conflict clearance, responsible attorney, package, signatures, completed-copy delivery, jurisdiction profile, and policy versions. | P0 | FIRM_POLICY / ATTY_AUTH | Schema test |

| RET-ACT-007 | Matter activated event | Successful activation shall emit canonical matter.activated using the normalized 18-field envelope. | P0 | FIRM_POLICY | Contract test |

| RET-ACT-008 | TRACE handoff | TRACE shall consume matter.activated idempotently with a tenant-scoped transfer manifest and source references. | P0 | SYS_ADMIN | Cross-product E2E test |

| RET-ACT-009 | Activation failure reconciliation | Unknown, timed-out, or partial activation results shall enter reconciliation; RETAINER shall not infer success. | P0 | SYS_ADMIN | Chaos/reconciliation test |

| RET-ACT-010 | Reissue workflow | Expired or invalidated packages shall require renewed authority, current template resolution, and a new immutable package version. | P1 | FIRM_POLICY | Reissue E2E test |

5.9 Administration and shared platform

| ID | Requirement | Normative statement | Priority | Authority | Verification |

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| RET-ADM-001 | SaaS Admin owns governance | Tenant users, roles, attorney verification, jurisdiction profiles, approved templates, communication policies, reminder policies, and entitlements shall remain governed through SaaS Admin contracts. | P0 | FIRM_POLICY | Ownership test |

| RET-ADM-002 | Immutable policy snapshot | Each material action shall store the exact effective policy/configuration version used at execution. | P0 | FIRM_POLICY | Audit test |

| RET-ADM-003 | Feature entitlements | RETAINER capabilities shall be enforced server-side using tenant entitlements and jurisdiction feature flags. | P0 | FIRM_POLICY | Entitlement bypass test |

| RET-ADM-004 | Template administration separation | SaaS Admin may manage metadata and approvals; RETAINER shall resolve and use approved versions without owning tenant identity or licensure truth. | P0 | ATTY_AUTH / FIRM_POLICY | Boundary test |

| RET-ADM-005 | Platform extensions registered | Any product-specific actor, event, action, state, or metric shall be registered with canonical/extension classification and version. | P0 | SYS_ADMIN | Registry lint test |

| RET-ADM-006 | No duplicate shared services | RETAINER shall consume shared contracts and adapters rather than create divergent definitions of authority, consent, documents, communications, audit, or integration types. | P0 | SYS_ADMIN | Dependency/duplicate-symbol test |

| RET-ADM-007 | Support access controls | TrueVow support access shall be least-privilege, reason-bound, time-bound, tenant-visible where policy requires, and audited. | P1 | FIRM_POLICY | JIT access test |

| RET-ADM-008 | Export portability | The firm shall be able to export engagement records, documents, evidence manifests, and audit history under tenant policy. | P1 | FIRM_POLICY | Export integrity test |

5.10 Audit and event controls

| ID | Requirement | Normative statement | Priority | Authority | Verification |

| --- | --- | --- | --- | --- | --- |

| RET-AUD-001 | Normalized event envelope | Every material RETAINER event shall use the shared envelope with the ontology fields plus required schema_version. | P0 | SYS_ADMIN | JSON Schema test |

| RET-AUD-002 | Append-only audit | Business audit evidence shall be append-only, tenant-scoped, idempotent by event_id, and independent of diagnostic logs. | P0 | SYS_ADMIN | Mutation/idempotency test |

| RET-AUD-003 | Authority linkage | Material events shall identify authority class and authority record; absence shall fail closed where authority is required. | P0 | SYS_ADMIN | Negative contract test |

| RET-AUD-004 | Correlation and causation | Commands, events, work items, communications, and provider callbacks shall preserve correlation_id and causation_id. | P0 | SYS_ADMIN | Trace test |

| RET-AUD-005 | No secrets in payload | Event payloads shall exclude credentials, private keys, raw access tokens, and unnecessary confidential document content. | P0 | PROHIBITED | Payload scanner test |

| RET-AUD-006 | Audit completeness | The system shall achieve 100 percent audit completeness for material RETAINER transitions before pilot activation. | P0 | SYS_ADMIN | Metric test |

| RET-AUD-007 | Replayability | A workflow shall be reconstructable from immutable commands/events plus referenced policy and document versions without relying on mutable logs. | P0 | SYS_ADMIN | Replay test |

6. Experience Architecture and Screens

6.1 Staff and attorney application information architecture

| Area | Primary screens | Primary records/actions |

| --- | --- | --- |

| Review | Representation Review Queue; Candidate Review | Matter Candidate projection, decision preparation, attorney assignment |

| Conflicts | Conflict Search; Candidate Detail; Attorney Conflict Decision | Search scope, matches, supporting records, clearance/hold |

| Packages | Template Resolution; Package Builder; Exact Preview | Template/version, merge fields, preflight, manifest, hashes |

| Engagements | Engagement Monitor; Timeline; Delivery/Signature Status | Workflow state, tasks, communications, signatures, expiration |

| Questions | Question Inbox; Question Thread | Classification, escalation, attorney response, SLA |

| Activation | Activation Checklist; Authorization; Reconciliation | Required conditions, evidence, command/result, TRACE handoff |

| Administration link-outs | SaaS Admin deep links | Users, attorneys, templates, policies, channels, integrations, entitlements |

6.2 Client portal screens

47. Access verification and firm identity.
48. Electronic transaction consent and delivery preference.
49. Package overview and downloadable documents.
50. Document review with clause/page question capture.
51. Legal-question waiting state and firm response.
52. Signature ceremony and signer intent.
53. Completion confirmation and completed-copy download.
54. Decline / stop reminders / accessibility assistance.

6.3 Screen-level rules

- Each screen has one primary action and displays the current authoritative business state separately from delivery/job status.
- Buttons for reserved actions include the required authority and never appear based only on a generic admin role.
- Every legal-sensitive automated result is labeled as a search result, draft, flag or administrative check—not a legal conclusion.
- Errors state what is missing and create a safe recovery path; no UI bypasses server-side gates.
- The client surface is tenant-branded and never presents TrueVow as the law firm.

6.4 Queue definitions

| Queue | Entry condition | Exit condition | SLA owner |

| --- | --- | --- | --- |

| Attorney review | Candidate current and review requested | Approved, declined or deferred | Named attorney / team policy |

| Conflict review | Search complete or material party changed | Attorney clearance/hold decision | Named attorney |

| Package completion | Approval+clearance present; data incomplete | Preflight passes | Staff |

| Legal questions | Question legal or uncertain | Attributable attorney response | Named attorney |

| Delivery failures | Provider reports failure / no retainable delivery | Successful retry or human resolution | Staff |

| Signature exceptions | Invalid/expired/mismatched signature evidence | Corrected ceremony or terminated workflow | Staff + attorney as needed |

| Activation reconciliation | Unknown/partial activation result | Canonical result established | Platform operations |

7. Domain and Data Architecture

7.1 RETAINER aggregates

| Aggregate | Purpose | Root / key invariants |

| --- | --- | --- |

| RepresentationDecision | Attorney-attributable accept/decline/defer decision | Append-only versions; attorney authority; defined scope |

| ConflictReview | Searches, possible matches and attorney clearance/hold | Search != candidate != clearance; party-set version |

| EngagementWorkflow | Canonical lifecycle orchestration | Only WorkflowRuntime transitions state; fail closed |

| TemplateResolution | Resolved effective template and policy inputs | Approved/effective version; deterministic mapping |

| EngagementPackage | Locked package manifest and shared document references | Immutable after delivery; hash parity |

| EngagementQuestion | Prospect question and firm response workflow | Legal/uncertain escalates; attributable response |

| SignatureCoordination | Ceremonies, signer requirements and evidence references | Signer authority, intent, document hash |

| ActivationChecklist | Versioned required conditions and evidence | All mandatory items pass; attorney activation authority |

7.2 RETAINER operational tables

| Table | Key columns | Notes |

| --- | --- | --- |

| retainer_workflows | id, tenant_id, candidate_id, state, version, decision_id, conflict_review_id, package_id, activation_checklist_id | Aggregate root; optimistic concurrency |

| representation_decisions | id, tenant_id, candidate_id, outcome, scope_json, attorney_actor_id, authority_record_id, supersedes_id | Append-only decision versions |

| conflict_searches | id, tenant_id, candidate_id, party_set_version, algorithm_version, scope_json, status | Deterministic search evidence |

| conflict_candidates | id, tenant_id, search_id, matched_party_ref, match_basis_json, score_or_rule, disposition | Possible matches only |

| conflict_reviews | id, tenant_id, search_id, outcome, attorney_actor_id, authority_record_id, rationale_ref | Clear/hold/exception |

| template_resolutions | id, tenant_id, workflow_id, template_definition_id, template_version, policy_version_id, inputs_json | Immutable snapshot |

| engagement_packages | id, tenant_id, workflow_id, manifest_json, status, package_hash, generated_at, locked_at | References shared DocumentVersion IDs |

| package_documents | package_id, document_version_id, role, required, sequence, hash | Manifest join |

| engagement_questions | id, tenant_id, workflow_id, document_version_id, page_or_clause_ref, classification, state, assigned_actor_id | Question workflow |

| signature_ceremonies | id, tenant_id, package_id, provider_type, provider_ref, state, expires_at | Provider-neutral |

| signer_requirements | id, ceremony_id, party_role_id, signer_role, authority_scope, required | Expected signers |

| signature_evidence_refs | id, ceremony_id, signer_requirement_id, shared_signature_evidence_id, validity_state | Shared evidence reference |

| activation_checklists | id, tenant_id, workflow_id, policy_version_id, state, version | Checklist root |

| activation_checklist_items | id, checklist_id, control_id, required, result, evidence_refs_json, evaluated_at | Objective/authority gates |

| reminder_schedules | id, tenant_id, workflow_id, policy_version_id, next_due_at, max_attempts, state | No canonical state mutation |

| reminder_attempts | id, schedule_id, communication_id, attempt_no, result | Communication evidence |

| retainer_inbox_events | event_id, tenant_id, event_type, schema_version, received_at, processed_at, payload_hash, result | Inbox/idempotency |

| retainer_outbox_events | event_id, tenant_id, aggregate_id, event_type, schema_version, payload_json, published_at | Transactional outbox |

| retainer_idempotency_keys | tenant_id, key, command_type, request_hash, result_ref, expires_at | Command safety |

| retainer_projection_checkpoints | projection_name, tenant_id, last_event_position, rebuilt_at | Rebuildable views |

7.3 Shared references, not duplicated records

- Tenant, User, Actor, RoleAssignment, JurisdictionProfile, FirmPolicy, AuthorityRecord and Entitlement IDs.
- Person, Organization, PartyRole, ContactPoint and PersonalRepresentativeAuthority IDs.
- MatterCandidate, Inquiry, IntakeSession, IntakeResponse and ConsentRecord IDs.
- TemplateDefinition, Document, DocumentVersion, SignatureEvidence, Communication, Notification, AuditEvent and WorkItem IDs.
- Matter, RepresentationRelationship and ResponsibleAttorneyAssignment IDs after activation.

7.4 Data ownership and consistency

RETAINER stores references and immutable snapshots necessary to explain its own decisions. It does not duplicate mutable identity, policy, document bytes or Matter truth. Cross-service consistency uses commands/events, idempotency keys, outbox/inbox and reconciliation—not distributed database transactions.

7.5 Sensitivity and retention defaults

| Data class | Examples | Default controls |

| --- | --- | --- |

| PROSPECT_CONFIDENTIAL | Candidate facts, conflict data, questions | Tenant isolation, encryption, restricted roles, audit |

| CLIENT_CONFIDENTIAL | Executed package, signer evidence after activation | Same plus matter access policy |

| ATTORNEY_WORK_PRODUCT | Conflict rationale, internal review notes | Exclude from client portal; strict access |

| IDENTITY_AUTH | Access tokens, authentication evidence | Never in event payload; short retention where appropriate |

| OPERATIONAL_METADATA | State, task, delivery result | Tenant scoped; minimize embedded confidential text |

8. Workflow and State-Machine Architecture

8.1 Canonical Engagement Workflow states

State	Meaning
---	---
NOT_STARTED	No firm-approved engagement workflow exists.
ATTORNEY_APPROVAL_RECORDED	Representation approval and scope are attributable.
CONFLICT_REVIEW_PENDING	Potential conflicts await review.
CONFLICT_HOLD	Workflow blocked by unresolved conflict concern.
PACKAGE_PREPARATION	Approved templates and facts are being assembled.
DELIVERY_AUTHORIZED	Required authority to deliver has been verified.
DELIVERED	Package reached the intended recipient.
CLIENT_REVIEW	Prospect is reviewing, asking questions, or awaiting counsel discussion.
SIGNATURE_PENDING	Required signatures are outstanding.
FULLY_EXECUTED	Required parties signed the locked package version.
ACTIVATION_PENDING	Non-signature activation conditions remain.
ACTIVATED	Matter and representation relationship were created.
DECLINED_OR_EXPIRED	Prospect declined, authorization was withdrawn, or package expired.

8.2 State diagram



8.3 Transition registry

ID	Command	From	To	Authority	Key guards	Event
----	---------	------	----	-----------	------------	-------

| --- | --- | --- | --- | --- | --- | --- |

| TR-RET-001 | ApproveRepresentation | NOT_STARTED | ATTORNEY_APPROVAL_RECORDED | ATTY_AUTH |
tenant.active_or_trial, candidate.current, actor.verified_attorney | representation.approved_by_attorney |

| TR-RET-002 | DeclineRepresentation | NOT_STARTED | DECLINED_OR_EXPIRED | ATTY_AUTH | tenant.active_or_trial,
candidate.current, actor.verified_attorney | representation.declined_by_attorney |

| TR-RET-003 | RequestConflictReview | ATTORNEY_APPROVAL_RECORDED | CONFLICT_REVIEW_PENDING | FIRM_POLICY |
search.completed, search.tenant_scoped | conflict.review_requested |

| TR-RET-004 | ApplyConflictHold | CONFLICT_REVIEW_PENDING, PACKAGE_PREPARATION | CONFLICT_HOLD | ATTY_AUTH |
actor.verified_attorney | conflict.hold_applied |

| TR-RET-005 | ClearConflict | CONFLICT_REVIEW_PENDING, CONFLICT_HOLD | PACKAGE_PREPARATION | ATTY_AUTH |
actor.verified_attorney, party_set.current | conflict.cleared_by_attorney |

| TR-RET-006 | ResolveTemplate | PACKAGE_PREPARATION | PACKAGE_PREPARATION | FIRM_POLICY |
jurisdiction_profile.effective, template.approved, template.current | template.resolved |

| TR-RET-007 | GeneratePackage | PACKAGE_PREPARATION | PACKAGE_PREPARATION | FIRM_POLICY | template.resolved,
merge_fields.valid, required_disclosures.present | package.generated |

| TR-RET-008 | AuthorizeDelivery | PACKAGE_PREPARATION | DELIVERY_AUTHORIZED | FIRM_POLICY |
representation.approved, conflict.cleared, package.locked, tenant.active_or_trial | package.delivery_authorized |

| TR-RET-009 | DeliverPackage | DELIVERY_AUTHORIZED | DELIVERED | SYS_ADMIN | channel.allowed, recipient.verified,
package.hash_matches | package.delivered |

| TR-RET-010 | BeginClientReview | DELIVERED | CLIENT_REVIEW | CLIENT_AUTH | access.valid, package.current |
engagement.client_review_started |

| TR-RET-011 | RequestSignatures | DELIVERED, CLIENT_REVIEW | SIGNATURE_PENDING | FIRM_POLICY |
esign_consent.effective, signer_requirements.complete | signature.requested |

| TR-RET-012 | ApplySignature | SIGNATURE_PENDING | SIGNATURE_PENDING | CLIENT_AUTH / ATTY_AUTH |
signer.authenticated, intent.captured, document.hash_matches | signature.applied |

| TR-RET-013 | InvalidateSignature | SIGNATURE_PENDING, FULLY_EXECUTED | SIGNATURE_PENDING | FIRM_POLICY /
ATTY_AUTH | reason.recorded, actor.authorized | signature.invalidated |

| TR-RET-014 | MarkFullyExecuted | SIGNATURE_PENDING | FULLY_EXECUTED | SYS_ADMIN | all_required_signatures.valid,
all_acknowledgments.complete, package.hash_matches | package.fully_executed |

| TR-RET-015 | DeliverCompletedCopy | FULLY_EXECUTED | ACTIVATION_PENDING | SYS_ADMIN | delivery.retainable,
final_hash.matches | completed_copy.delivered |

| TR-RET-016 | AuthorizeMatterActivation | ACTIVATION_PENDING | ACTIVATION_PENDING | ATTY_AUTH |
checklist.all_required_pass, actor.verified_attorney | matter.activation_authorized |

| TR-RET-017 | ConfirmMatterActivated | ACTIVATION_PENDING | ACTIVATED | FIRM_POLICY | matter_id.present,
activation_id.matches, event.valid | matter.activated |

| TR-RET-018 | ExpireEngagement | ATTORNEY_APPROVAL_RECORDED, CONFLICT_REVIEW_PENDING, CONFLICT_HOLD,
PACKAGE_PREPARATION, DELIVERY_AUTHORIZED, DELIVERED, CLIENT_REVIEW, SIGNATURE_PENDING, FULLY_EXECUTED,
ACTIVATION_PENDING | DECLINED_OR_EXPIRED | FIRM_POLICY | policy.due, no_activation_success | engagement.expired |

| TR-RET-019 | RecordClientDecline | DELIVERED, CLIENT_REVIEW, SIGNATURE_PENDING | DECLINED_OR_EXPIRED |
CLIENT_AUTH | actor.matches_recipient | engagement.declined_by_client |

| TR-RET-020 | WithdrawAuthorization | ATTORNEY_APPROVAL_RECORDED, CONFLICT_REVIEW_PENDING, CONFLICT_HOLD,
PACKAGE_PREPARATION, DELIVERY_AUTHORIZED, DELIVERED, CLIENT_REVIEW, SIGNATURE_PENDING, FULLY_EXECUTED,
ACTIVATION_PENDING | DECLINED_OR_EXPIRED | ATTY_AUTH | actor.verified_attorney, matter.not_activated |
engagement.authorization_withdrawn |

8.4 Runtime rules

- Only WorkflowRuntime may mutate `retainer_workflows.state`.
- Every command supplies expected aggregate version; mismatches return a retryable concurrency error.
- A transition contract names prior states, destination, authority, evidence, guards, event and fail-closed behavior.
- Self-transitions may record material events without inventing UI/job states.
- Delivery queues, provider jobs, reminders and projections never redefine canonical workflow state.
- Terminal workflow reissue creates a new workflow/package version rather than rewriting history.

9. Event and Command Architecture

9.1 EventEnvelope v1.0.1

The normalized contract contains 18 required fields. `schema_version` is the explicit patch needed to make the ontology rule `schema_versioned` executable.

Field	Purpose
---	---
<code>event_id</code>	Globally unique idempotency key
<code>event_type</code>	Stable dot-notated event name
<code>occurred_at</code>	Business occurrence time
<code>recorded_at</code>	Event-store persistence time
<code>tenant_id</code>	Non-null tenant boundary
<code>aggregate_type</code>	Canonical aggregate type
<code>aggregate_id</code>	Aggregate identifier
<code>aggregate_version</code>	Version after event
<code>actor_type</code>	Actor classification
<code>actor_id</code>	Attributable actor/reference
<code>authority_class</code>	One of six canonical classes
<code>authority_record_id</code>	Evidence of authority where required
<code>policy_version_id</code>	Exact policy/configuration snapshot
<code>correlation_id</code>	End-to-end workflow trace
<code>causation_id</code>	Immediate causal command/event
<code>payload</code>	Schema-validated minimal payload
<code>sensitivity_class</code>	Handling/retention classification
<code>schema_version</code>	Payload/envelope schema version

9.2 Canonical RETAINER events

- `conflict.search_started`
- `conflict.candidate_detected`
- `conflict.review_requested`
- `conflict.cleared_by_attorney`
- `conflict.hold_applied`
- `representation.approved_by_attorney`
- `representation.declined_by_attorney`
- `engagement.workflow_started`
- `template.resolved`
- `package.generated`
- `package.delivery_authorized`
- `esign.consent_granted`
- `package.delivered`
- `engagement.question_received`
- `engagement.question_escalated`
- `signature.applied`

- signature.invalidated
- package.fully_executed
- completed_copy.delivered
- matter.activation_authorized
- matter.activated
- engagement.expired

9.3 RETAINER/product extension events

Event	Owner	Canonical?	Schema
---	---	---	---
candidate.submitted_for_representation_review	INTAKE	false	1.0.0
engagement.client_review_started	RETAINER	false	1.0.0
signature.requested	RETAINER	false	1.0.0
engagement.declined_by_client	RETAINER	false	1.0.0
engagement.authorization_withdrawn	RETAINER	false	1.0.0
engagement.delivery_failed	RETAINER	false	1.0.0
engagement.reminder_sent	RETAINER	false	1.0.0
engagement.reminder_suppressed	RETAINER	false	1.0.0
engagement.reconciliation_required	RETAINER	false	1.0.0

9.4 Command semantics

- Commands are imperative requests and are not facts.
- A command carries actor, authority evidence, policy snapshot reference, expected aggregate version and idempotency key.
- A rejected command emits an audit denial/operational result but does not emit the requested business event.
- Events are past-tense facts and never instruct consumers to perform legal judgment.

9.5 Delivery guarantees

Concern	Control
---	---
Producer atomicity	Domain write + outbox event in one local database transaction
At-least-once delivery	Outbox publisher retries with backoff
Consumer idempotency	Inbox keyed by event_id and payload hash
Ordering	Per aggregate_version monotonic validation; gaps trigger reconciliation
Schema evolution	Backward-compatible additive changes within major; explicit adapter for breaking version
Poison events	Quarantine with tenant-safe metadata and human work item
Replay	Consumer/projection checkpoints; no side-effect replay without explicit mode

10. Service and Deployment Architecture

10.1 Recommended repository/deployables

```
TrueVow-RETAINER/
  apps/
    web/          # Next.js staff/attorney + client portal
    api/          # FastAPI command/query API
  workers/
    workflow/     # timers, reminders, escalations
    events/       # inbox/outbox, projections, reconciliation
  packages/
    retainer-domain/
    retainer-contracts/
    ui/
  registries/
  alembic/
  tests/
  docs/
```

10.2 Logical components

Component	Responsibility	Must not do
RETAINER Web	Firm workflows, client portal, accessible experience	Enforce authority only in browser
RETAINER API	Commands, queries, auth context, orchestration	Read other product databases
RETAINER Domain	Aggregates, invariants, command handlers	Call providers directly
Workflow Worker	Timers, reminders, work-item escalation	Mutate canonical state outside runtime
Event Worker	Outbox publish, inbox consume, projections, reconciliation	Infer legal/business success from transport success
Shared adapters	Authority, policy, consent, document, communication, audit, integration	Redefine shared contracts
PostgreSQL	RETAINER aggregates, inbox/outbox, projections	Store credentials or mutable shared truth
Redis (optional)	Short locks, rate limits, queue coordination	Permanent business state

10.3 Technology baseline

- Python 3.12+ / FastAPI / Pydantic v2 / SQLAlchemy 2 / Alembic.
- Next.js with TypeScript and server-side authorization-aware data access.
- PostgreSQL with tenant_id on every tenant-owned table and RLS where supported.
- Shared truevow-contracts package generated from registry/schema sources.
- Transactional outbox/inbox; message transport may be PostgreSQL polling initially and NATS or another broker later without changing contracts.
- Object bytes remain in shared Document Service storage; RETAINER stores references/hashes.

10.4 Deployment environments

Environment	Purpose	Data policy
local	Developer workflows and contract tests	Synthetic data only
test	Automated integration/chaos tests	Synthetic fixtures
staging	Full provider sandbox and migration rehearsal	Synthetic/de-identified only

| pilot | Selected California tenant(s) | Production controls; feature flags; heightened audit |

| production | Approved supported tenants/jurisdictions | Full SLO, backup, retention, incident controls |

11. API Contracts

11.1 API conventions

- Base path /api/v1 and explicit versioned schemas.
- Tenant is derived from authenticated context and cross-checked against resource tenant.
- Mutating requests require Idempotency-Key and expected aggregate version.
- Reserved actions require authority evidence reference; server evaluates it.
- Responses include canonical resource IDs, version, state and correlation ID.
- Errors use stable machine codes and never leak cross-tenant existence.

11.2 Primary command endpoints

Method/path	Purpose	Required authority
---	---	---
POST /candidates/import	Internal candidate handoff intake	SYS_ADMIN service identity
POST /candidates/{id}/decisions	Approve, decline or defer representation	ATTY_AUTH
POST /workflows/{id}/conflict-searches	Run configured conflict search	FIRM_POLICY / STAFF_AUTH
POST /conflict-reviews/{id}/decisions	Clear, hold or approve exception	ATTY_AUTH
POST /workflows/{id}/template-resolution	Resolve effective approved template	FIRM_POLICY
POST /workflows/{id}/packages	Generate package after preflight	FIRM_POLICY / STAFF_AUTH
POST /packages/{id}/authorize-delivery	Authorize delivery	FIRM_POLICY
POST /packages/{id}/deliver	Execute delivery	SYS_ADMIN after gate
POST /portal/sessions	Create/redeem secure portal session	CLIENT_AUTH context
POST /workflows/{id}/questions	Submit question	CLIENT_AUTH
POST /questions/{id}/responses	Respond to escalated question	ATTY_AUTH where legal
POST /packages/{id}/signature-ceremonies	Create provider-neutral ceremony	FIRM_POLICY
POST /signature-callbacks/{provider}	Receive verified provider callback	Provider service identity
POST /workflows/{id}/activation-checklists/evaluate	Evaluate objective checklist	SYS_ADMIN
POST /workflows/{id}/authorize-activation	Named-attorney authorization	ATTY_AUTH
POST /workflows/{id}/activate	Send canonical activation command	FIRM_POLICY after gates
POST /workflows/{id}/expire	Apply firm expiration policy	FIRM_POLICY
POST /workflows/{id}/withdraw	Withdraw pre-activation authorization	ATTY_AUTH

11.3 Primary query endpoints

Method/path	Purpose
---	---
GET /review-queue	Tenant-scoped representation review projection
GET /workflows/{id}	Workflow detail and current evidence summary
GET /workflows/{id}/timeline	Material event timeline
GET /conflict-reviews/{id}	Search scope, matches and decision history
GET /packages/{id}	Manifest, versions, preflight and delivery/signature status

GET /questions	Tenant/assignee question queue
GET /activation-queue	Checklist and reconciliation projection
GET /portal/packages/{token}	Authorized client package projection

11.4 Error codes

Code	Meaning	Retry?
---	---	---
RET_AUTHORITY_MISSING	Required authority/evidence absent	No until corrected
RET_POLICY_INACTIVE	No effective policy/profile	No until configured
RET_STATE_CONFLICT	Command not allowed from current state/version	Refresh/re-evaluate
RET_TENANT_MISMATCH	Tenant boundary mismatch	No; security event
RET_TEMPLATE_UNRESOLVED	No effective approved template	No until configured
RET_PREFLIGHT_FAILED	Required package data/control missing	After correction
RET_DOCUMENT_HASH_MISMATCH	Bytes differ from locked version	No; incident/reconciliation
RET_CONSENT_NOT_EFFECTIVE	Required consent absent/revoked	After valid consent
RET_SIGNATURE_INVALID	Signature evidence invalid or mismatched	After re-execution
RET_ACTIVATION_UNKNOWN	Activation result uncertain	Reconciliation only

12. Cross-Product Integration Contracts

12.1 INTAKE -> RETAINER candidate handoff

```
event_type: candidate.submitted_for_representation_review
required references:
  tenant_id
  matter_candidate_id
  candidate_version
  prospective_client_party_role_ids[]
  intake_session_ids[]
  qualification_assessment_id?
  consent_record_ids[]
  communication_ids[]
  source_event_ids[]
  submitted_by_actor_id
  submitted_at
constraints:
  - candidate is not a Matter
  - no representation approval implied
  - immutable source references
  - idempotent by event_id
```

12.2 SaaS Admin -> RETAINER governance resolution

| Contract | Inputs | Outputs |

| --- | --- | --- |

| ResolveActionAuthority | tenant, actor, action, aggregate, state | allow/deny, authority class, record ID, reason |

| ResolvePolicySnapshot | tenant, policy type, effective time, jurisdiction | immutable policy ID/version/hash |

| ResolveJurisdictionProfile | tenant, jurisdiction, workflow type | status, effective version, enabled controls |

| ResolveTemplate | tenant, jurisdiction, matter type, fee type, effective time | approved template/version/hash/merge schema |

| ResolveEntitlements | tenant, product/capability | enabled, limits, effective version |

| ResolveActor | tenant, user/actor, action | roles, attorney verification, authority eligibility |

12.3 RETAINER -> canonical Matter activation

```
command: ActivateMatter
idempotency_key: <workflow_id>:<activation_version>
evidence:
  representation_decision_id
  conflict_review_id
  engagement_workflow_id
  engagement_package_id
  executed_document_version_ids[]
  signature_evidence_ids[]
  completed_copy_delivery_id
  responsible_attorney_assignment_request
  jurisdiction_profile_version_id
  activation_policy_version_id
  activation_authority_record_id
  source_manifest_hash
result:
  activation_id
  matter_id
  representation_relationship_id
  responsible_attorney_assignment_id
  aggregate_version
  event_id
```

12.4 matter.activated -> TRACE

- TRACE consumes the canonical event, not RETAINER private tables.
- TRACE verifies tenant, schema, activation evidence references and idempotency.
- TRACE stores source references and creates its case-production context only once.
- Unknown/unsupported events enter reconciliation without changing case state.

12.5 SETTLE relationship

There is no direct RETAINER-to-SETTLE dependency in v1. SETTLE may later retrieve the executed fee agreement, scope, amendments and authority records through shared Matter/Document services using tenant permissions. It must not call RETAINER private storage.

13. Templates, Documents, Consent and Signatures

13.1 Template governance

- 55. Draft template created under tenant.
- 56. Named attorney reviews and approves exact version.
- 57. Jurisdiction, practice area, fee arrangement, effective dates and merge schema assigned.
- 58. SHA-256 hash and approval evidence stored.
- 59. SaaS Admin activates mapping policy.
- 60. Supersession creates new version; prior versions remain available for evidence.

13.2 Package preflight controls

- | Control | Failure behavior |
- | --- | --- |
- | Effective California jurisdiction profile | Block |
- | Attorney-approved template/version | Block |
- | Current representation approval/scope | Block |
- | Current conflict clearance for current party set | Block |
- | Required client/firm identity fields | Block |
- | Fee rate and scope selected by attorney/policy | Block |
- | Required disclosures and acknowledgments | Block |
- | Merge-field provenance and validation | Block |
- | Preview bytes/hash parity | Block |

13.3 Consent ledger uses

- | Consent type | Required before | Revocation effect |
- | --- | --- | --- |
- | Electronic transaction | Electronic delivery/signature | Stop new e-sign activity; offer approved alternative |
- | SMS | Automated SMS reminder | Suppress SMS immediately |
- | Recording/transcription | Any recorded engagement communication | Stop future recording; preserve history per policy |
- | Data sharing/integration | Feature-specific external transmission where required | Disable future transmission; route review |

13.4 Signature-provider adapter contract

- Create ceremony with document hashes and signer requirements.
- Generate provider session/link without exposing provider-specific IDs as canonical identities.
- Verify callback authenticity and replay protection.
- Map provider status to canonical ceremony/evidence states.
- Fetch final bytes and confirm hashes.
- Store provider raw evidence under retention policy while preserving normalized SignatureEvidence.
- Support cancellation, expiration, invalidation and export.

14. Communications and Reminders

14.1 Message classes

| Class | Examples | Controls |

| --- | --- | --- |

| Transactional | Package available, signature needed, completed copy, delivery failure | Firm identity, content version, permitted channel |

| Legal-question notice | Question assigned, attorney response available | No legal content in notification unless approved |

| Reminder | Unsigned package, incomplete consent | Policy cadence, quiet hours, attempt limits, suppression |

| Operational escalation | Delivery failed, SLA breached, activation unknown | Internal recipient and work item |

| Marketing | Not part of RETAINER engagement stream | Must remain separate and respect suppression |

14.2 Reminder policy fields

```
policy_id, version, channels, initial_delay, intervals[], max_attempts, quiet_hours,
expiration_after, stop_conditions[], escalation_after, sender_profile_id,
message_template_versions, jurisdiction_scope, effective_from, effective_to
```

14.3 Stop conditions

- All required signatures complete.
- Client declines or revokes channel consent.
- Attorney withdraws authorization.
- Package expires or is superseded.
- Tenant becomes inactive.
- Security/compliance hold.
- Recipient contact point becomes invalid or suppressed.

15. Security, Privacy, Retention and Audit

15.1 Tenant isolation

- Every RETAINER table row carries non-null tenant_id and indexed access path.
- Authorization derives tenant from identity context; request tenant values are never trusted alone.
- RLS and application-layer checks both enforce isolation where available.
- Object/document access uses tenant-scoped shared-service authorization and short-lived URLs.
- Cross-tenant identifiers return not-found behavior and create security telemetry.

15.2 Security controls

Control area	Requirement	
---	---	
Authentication	Firm SSO/session through shared identity; secure client portal tokens with revocation/step-up	
Authorization	Server-side Authority Gate on every command and sensitive query	
Encryption	TLS in transit; encryption at rest; shared key-management policy	
Secrets	Managed secret store; never database/event payload/source control	
Support access	Just-in-time, reason-bound, time-limited, audited	
Callbacks	Signature verification, replay protection, provider IP/rate controls where appropriate	
Rate limiting	Tenant/user/token/provider limits; abuse detection	
Dependency security	Pinned dependencies, SBOM, vulnerability scanning, secret scanning	
Secure SDLC	Threat model, code review, SAST, DAST, penetration testing	

15.3 Retention and deletion

- Retention class is assigned to each aggregate, document/evidence reference and event.
- Legal hold overrides ordinary deletion.
- Subscription termination does not automatically delete engagement evidence.
- Deletion is a governed, auditable process after tenant instruction and retention/hold checks.
- Exports include manifests and checksums; exported data does not remove the platform retention duty until deletion is authorized.

15.4 Audit event minimum

Every material action records tenant, event ID/type/schema, actor, authority, policy version, aggregate/version, prior and resulting state where applicable, correlation/causation, evidence references, result, timestamp and sensitivity class. Diagnostic logs may point to event IDs but are not the source of business evidence.

16. Reliability, Observability and Operations

16.1 Service objectives

| Measure | Pilot target | Notes |

| --- | --- | --- |

| API availability | 99.9% monthly excluding planned maintenance | Authority/policy dependencies included in critical path |

| Command p95 latency | < 750 ms excluding external document/e-sign operations | Reserved actions may require external checks |

| Query p95 latency | < 500 ms | Tenant-scoped projections |

| Outbox publication | 99% within 30 seconds; 100% eventual or alerted | No silent event loss |

| Reminder timer accuracy | Within 5 minutes of policy due time | Respect quiet hours |

| Audit completeness | 100% material events | Launch blocker |

| Cross-tenant incidents | 0 | Launch/incident severity critical |

| Document hash mismatches | 0 unresolved | Security/activation blocker |

16.2 Required telemetry

- Command counts, success/deny/failure by action and reason.
- Workflow counts by canonical state and age.
- Attorney review and conflict review latency.
- Package preflight failures by control.
- Delivery and signature provider latency/failure.
- Question SLA and escalation counts.
- Activation success/unknown/reconciliation counts.
- Outbox/inbox lag and poison events.
- Policy/version coverage and audit completeness.
- Tenant isolation denials and security exceptions.

16.3 Operational runbooks

61. Signature provider outage.
62. Email/SMS provider outage.
63. Document hash mismatch.
64. Authority or policy service unavailable.
65. Matter activation timeout/unknown result.
66. Outbox backlog or duplicate event conflict.
67. Cross-tenant access alert.
68. Client portal token compromise.
69. Template/policy emergency supersession.
70. Data export, legal hold and tenant offboarding.

17. Testing and Quality Gates

17.1 Test pyramid

| Layer | Coverage |

| --- | --- |

| Registry/schema lint | YAML/JSON/OpenAPI validity, canonical IDs, no duplicate event/state/action names |

| Unit | Aggregates, invariants, policy decisions, merge validation, hash/evidence logic |

| State-machine contract | Every transition allowed/denied from every state and authority class |

| Service integration | Shared authority/policy/consent/document/communication/audit adapters |

| Cross-product contract | INTAKE handoff, SaaS Admin resolution, Matter activation, TRACE consumption |

| E2E browser/API | Staff happy/exception paths and client portal/signature paths |

| Security | Tenant isolation, role bypass, token abuse, callback forgery, injection, IDOR |

| Resilience/chaos | Provider outages, duplicate/gap/reordered events, timeouts, retries, projection rebuild |

| Migration | Forward/backward compatibility, rollback, reference-data version checks |

17.2 Mandatory negative tests

- Staff attempts to approve representation.
- No-match conflict search attempts to clear conflict.
- AI/service actor attempts self-authorization.
- Inactive tenant attempts delivery/signature/activation.
- Delivered document bytes differ from locked hash.
- Client signs a different document version.
- Revoked SMS consent followed by scheduled reminder.
- Matter activation called without completed-copy delivery.
- Duplicate activation command with changed payload.
- Cross-tenant candidate/package/token access.
- Unsupported jurisdiction/profile/template.
- Missing schema_version in event.

17.3 Acceptance scenario catalog

The companion build pack includes executable-style YAML scenarios covering happy path, decline, defer, conflict hold, party-change invalidation, question escalation, consent decline, signature invalidation, provider outage, expiration, withdrawal, activation timeout, duplicate events and cross-tenant denial.

17.4 CI release gates

71. All unit/integration/contract/security tests pass.
72. Ruff, type checking, ESLint/TypeScript and formatting pass.
73. Database migration upgrade/downgrade rehearsal passes.
74. Shared contract compatibility matrix passes against deployed versions.
75. No P0 requirement lacks a passing test reference.
76. Threat model and dependency/SBOM checks pass.
77. Audit completeness and tenant-isolation test suites pass 100 percent.
78. Staging E2E with provider sandboxes passes.

18. Repository Structure and Coding Standards

18.1 Suggested tree

```
apps/api/app/
  api/v1/
    domain/
      representation/
      conflicts/
      engagement/
      templates/
      packages/
      questions/
      signatures/
      activation/
    application/commands/
    application/queries/
    application/projections/
  adapters/
  shared_contracts/
  db/
  security/
workers/
registries/
tests/unit/
tests/contracts/
tests/integration/
tests/e2e/
tests/security/
```

18.2 Coding rules

- Domain aggregates do not import web frameworks, provider SDKs or another product models.
- Commands and events use typed schemas and stable versioning.
- No bare strings for canonical IDs where typed enums/value objects are possible.
- No state assignment outside WorkflowRuntime.
- No direct shared-table mutation unless the shared service explicitly owns the call contract.
- Every database query includes tenant context by construction.
- Retries require idempotency and bounded backoff.
- Exceptions map to stable error codes and safe user messages.
- PII/confidential content is minimized in logs and events.
- Tests are required with every registry, transition, permission or contract change.

18.3 Shared contracts package

```
truevow-contracts/
  ontology/ids.py
  authority/classes.py
  events/envelope.schema.json
  events/catalog.yaml
  transitions/contract.schema.json
  entities/references.py
  errors/codes.py
  compatibility/manifest.json
  generated/ # language-specific generated types
```

19. Build Sequence and Coding-Agent Work Packages

19.1 Delivery sequence

| Package | Outcome |

| --- | --- |

| BP-00 Contract normalization | Patch EventEnvelope to 18 fields; freeze six authority classes; classify canonical/extension events; publish shared package; name Matter activation owner. |

| BP-01 Repository bootstrap | Create monorepo/deployables, CI, health/version endpoints, DB, tenant context, inbox/outbox, idempotency and shared adapters. |

| BP-02 Candidate and representation review | Consume INTAKE handoff; review queue; RepresentationDecision; attorney assignment; approve/decline/defer; audit. |

| BP-03 Conflict workflow | Deterministic search; candidates; attorney decision; hold/reopen; party-change invalidation; tests. |

| BP-04 Templates and packages | Resolve approved template; merge schema; preflight; package manifest; exact preview; immutable hashes. |

| BP-05 Client portal | Secure access, firm branding, electronic consent, document review, questions, decline/fallback. |

| BP-06 Signatures | Provider adapter, ceremonies, signer requirements, evidence, invalidation, fully executed and completed-copy delivery. |

| BP-07 Communications | Transactional email, consent-aware SMS flag, reminders, suppression, delivery failure and escalation. |

| BP-08 Activation and TRACE handoff | Checklist, attorney authorization, activation command/result, matter.activated, TRACE manifest, reconciliation. |

| BP-09 Pilot hardening | Security, chaos, export, legal hold, observability, runbooks, performance, California feature flags. |

19.2 Coding-agent execution rules

79. Read ontology registry, shared contract schemas, this specification and relevant package instructions before coding.
80. Do not rename canonical IDs or create aliases without registry change.
81. Inspect the current repository and reuse existing shared services/contracts.
82. Implement only one build package at a time with migrations, tests and rollback notes.
83. Never weaken fail-closed behavior to make a test pass.
84. No authority-sensitive action is implemented as a front-end-only check.
85. Provide a file-by-file change summary and test evidence.
86. Stop and report contract mismatch rather than inventing an interpretation.
87. Preserve backward compatibility for already deployed event consumers.
88. Do not modify INTAKE, SaaS Admin, TRACE or SETTLE databases from RETAINER.

19.3 Definition of complete for each package

- Requirements mapped to code/tests.
- Schemas/registries valid and versioned.
- Migrations include upgrade and downgrade.
- Unit, contract and integration tests pass.
- Authority, tenant and audit negative tests included.
- Observability and error codes added.
- Documentation/runbook updated.
- No unresolved P0 security or data-integrity issue.

20. Acceptance Criteria and Launch Gates

20.1 Product acceptance

- A California direct tenant prospect can complete the full approved engagement workflow and enter TRACE without duplicate entry.
- Staff can prepare work while attorney/client reserved decisions remain attributable and nondelegated.
- The firm can explain exactly which template, policy, authority, document bytes, consent, signatures and events supported activation.
- Every exception has a visible queue, owner and recovery path.

20.2 Architecture acceptance

- No direct database integration with another product.
- No duplicate shared ontology/authority/event definitions.
- Only WorkflowRuntime mutates canonical state.
- All transmitted/signed bytes are immutable and hash-verified.
- Matter creation occurs only through canonical activation contract.
- Projections are rebuildable from event/reference sources.
- Unknown external results do not silently change business state.

20.3 Security/compliance acceptance

- Zero confirmed cross-tenant access paths.
- 100 percent material audit completeness.
- Every P0 authority action has positive and negative tests.
- Client legal questions never receive automated legal explanations.
- No AI/service actor can create or satisfy its own authority record.
- Consent revocation and communication suppression are race-tested.
- Legal hold and retention controls override deletion.

20.4 California pilot activation flags

| Flag | Pilot value |

| --- | --- |

| jurisdiction | CA |

| agreement_type | PI_CONTINGENCY_6147 |

| direct_tenant_leads_only | true |

| named_attorney_representation_approval | required |

| named_attorney_conflict_clearance | required |

| named_attorney_activation | required |

| ai_authority_path | disabled |

| ai_legal_explanation | disabled |

| cross_firm_referral | disabled |

| sms_reminders | disabled until tenant/counsel/channel config effective |

| automated_voice_reminders | disabled |

| translated_authoritative_agreements | disabled |

20.5 Founder-level success measures

Metric	Definition / use
---	---
Attorney review latency	Decision time minus review requested, excluding prospect-information wait
Engagement completion rate	Activated engagements / delivered approved packages, segmented by decline/expiry/question
Time to activation	Matter activated minus attorney representation approval
Question escalation latency	Attributable attorney response minus legal-question receipt
Second-workflow adoption	Firms completing a second qualifying RETAINER workflow during onboarding
Authority-gate denial rate	Denied material actions / attempted material actions, reviewed for training or misuse
Audit completeness	Material events with complete actor/authority/policy/object/result evidence

Appendix A. Canonical Traceability

A.1 Ontology entities used by RETAINER

ID	Entity	Owner	Use
---	---	---	---
ENT-001	Tenant	Shared Platform	A law firm customer security and data boundary.
ENT-002	Office	COMMAND	Operational location or business unit within a tenant.
ENT-004	Role Assignment	Shared Platform	Time-bounded grant of permissions and responsibilities.
ENT-005	Jurisdiction Profile	Compliance Control Plane	Versioned package of rules, constraints, and supported workflows for a jurisdiction.
ENT-006	Firm Policy	Compliance Control Plane	Tenant-approved rule governing administrative execution.
ENT-007	Authority Record	Compliance Control Plane	Evidence that a named actor may approve a defined action.
ENT-008	Configuration Version	Shared Platform	Immutable snapshot of operational configuration.
ENT-011	Person	Shared Platform	Canonical natural-person identity independent of role.
ENT-012	Organization	Shared Platform	Canonical legal or operational organization identity.
ENT-013	Party Role	Shared Platform	Context-specific role of a Person or Organization.
ENT-014	Contact Point	Shared Platform	Email, phone, postal address, or channel endpoint with verification status.
ENT-016	Representation Relationship	RETAINER	Defined lawyer-client relationship for a scope and matter.
ENT-017	Responsible Attorney Assignment	Shared Platform	Accountability assignment for a matter or decision.
ENT-018	Personal Representative Authority	RETAINER	Evidence and scope by which one person acts for another.
ENT-022	Communication	Shared Platform	Message, call, voicemail, email, SMS, or portal interaction.
ENT-024	Consent Record	Shared Platform	Versioned, attributable grant or revocation of permission.
ENT-025	Matter Candidate	INTAKE	Structured prospect-and-incident record for firm review.
ENT-027	Conflict Search	RETAINER	Search execution across parties and relationships.
ENT-028	Conflict Candidate	RETAINER	Potential match requiring legal review.
ENT-031	Representation Decision	RETAINER	Attorney-attributable decision to accept, decline, or defer representation.
ENT-032	Engagement Workflow	RETAINER	Stateful process from firm approval through completed engagement conditions.
ENT-033	Template Definition	RETAINER	Versioned attorney-approved legal or administrative template.
ENT-034	Engagement Package	RETAINER	Set of documents and disclosures delivered together.
ENT-035	Engagement Agreement	RETAINER	Agreement defining scope, fees, costs, and other terms.
ENT-036	Disclosure	RETAINER	Required or firm-approved information presented separately or within package.
ENT-037	Signature Ceremony	RETAINER	Bounded electronic or wet-sign process.
ENT-038	Signature Evidence	RETAINER	Immutable evidence supporting a signature.
ENT-039	Engagement Question	RETAINER	Prospect/client question about agreement or representation.
ENT-040	Activation Checklist	RETAINER	Firm-approved requirements for creating an active matter.
ENT-041	Matter	Shared Business Core	Canonical represented legal engagement with lifecycle and scope.
ENT-107	Work Item	COMMAND	Actionable unit of work with owner, due date, policy, and state.
ENT-110	Service Level Policy	COMMAND	Target response or completion time and escalation rules.

- | ENT-112 | Notification | Shared Platform | System-generated or user-triggered communication about an event. |
- | ENT-115 | Document Version | Shared Platform | Immutable binary/text version and metadata. |
- | ENT-119 | Legal Hold | Compliance Control Plane | Instruction suspending normal deletion for defined data. |

A.2 Invariants enforced

- | Invariant | RETAINER enforcement |
- | --- | --- |
- | INV-001 Tenant isolation | Every tenant-owned entity carries a non-null tenant_id, and access is denied unless an active authorization path exists. |
- | INV-002 No candidate-to-client shortcut | A Matter Candidate cannot become a Matter without an attorney-attributable Representation Decision and activation gates. |
- | INV-003 Conflict separation | Conflict search, conflict candidate detection, and conflict clearance are distinct events and authorities. |
- | INV-004 Responsible attorney required | Every active Matter has at least one current Responsible Attorney Assignment. |
- | INV-005 Client settlement authority | No settlement acceptance transition occurs without an attributable client or valid representative decision. |
- | INV-006 Immutable transmitted version | Every sent, filed, or executed document references an immutable Document Version and hash. |
- | INV-007 Derived facts require provenance | Every material Normalized Fact and Timeline Event links to one or more Source Citations or is explicitly marked user-authored without source. |
- | INV-008 Contradictions are preserved | A later fact cannot overwrite a conflicting earlier fact; the conflict is represented explicitly. |
- | INV-009 Signals are not conclusions | Risk flags, scores, treatment gaps, and readiness indicators remain reviewable signals unless a human authority adopts them. |
- | INV-010 Policy-at-execution | Every material automated action stores the exact effective policy/configuration version used. |
- | INV-011 No self-approval | A service or AI component cannot create the authority record needed to approve its own proposed action. |
- | INV-012 Consent history preserved | Consent grants, refusals, revocations, expirations, and supersessions are append-only events. |
- | INV-013 Money reconciliation | Settlement allocations and disbursements must reconcile to cleared funds and immutable ledger entries. |
- | INV-014 Legal hold precedence | Legal hold prevents deletion regardless of ordinary retention schedule. |
- | INV-015 Audit/log separation | Business audit evidence is not derived solely from mutable diagnostic logs. |
- | INV-016 External system ambiguity | External sync status never silently changes the authoritative business state without a mapped, validated event. |
- | INV-017 Jurisdiction gating | A jurisdiction-dependent workflow cannot activate without an approved, effective jurisdiction profile. |
- | INV-018 Role does not create licensure | Administrative role or tenant ownership never implies attorney authority. |
- | INV-019 Matter closure is not deletion | Closed matters remain subject to retention, access, accounting, and continuing-duty rules. |
- | INV-020 AI remains nonauthoritative | AI outputs are drafts, extractions, classifications, or signals until accepted by an authorized human or deterministic approved rule. |

A.3 Metrics

| ID | Metric | Definition | Guardrail |

| --- | --- | --- | --- |

| MET-003 | Attorney review latency | Representation decision time - review requested time | Exclude periods awaiting prospect information. |

| MET-004 | Engagement completion rate | Activated engagements / delivered approved packages | Track decline, expiry, question escalation separately. |

| MET-005 | Time to representation activation | Matter activated - attorney approval recorded | Do not start clock from marketing contact by default. |

| MET-006 | Second-workflow adoption | Firms completing a second qualifying workflow within defined onboarding window | A behavioral-adoption hypothesis, not a contractual KPI. |

| MET-015 | Authority-gate denial rate | Denied material actions / attempted material actions | Investigate repeated attempts; not automatically negative. |

| MET-016 | Audit completeness | Material events with actor, authority, policy, object, result / material events | Target 100%. |

| MET-018 | Policy-version coverage | Automated actions referencing immutable policy version / automated actions | Target 100% for material actions. |

Appendix B. Build Pack Contents

- Machine-readable RETAINER states, transitions, events, authority actions and workflow policies.
- EventEnvelope JSON Schema v1.0.1.
- Candidate handoff and Matter activation JSON Schemas.
- OpenAPI starter contract.
- PostgreSQL schema seed for RETAINER-owned operational tables.
- Acceptance scenario YAML.
- Requirement traceability CSV.
- Coding-agent build sequence and do-not-regress checklist.

Appendix C. Final Non-Negotiables

- 89. A candidate is not a client or Matter.
- 90. A conflict search result is not conflict clearance.
- 91. A signature is not by itself matter activation.
- 92. Transport success is not legal/business authorization.
- 93. An admin role is not attorney authority.
- 94. An AI output is not an authority record.
- 95. A mutable log is not audit evidence.
- 96. A UI status is not canonical business state.
- 97. Another product database is not an integration API.
- 98. Missing or uncertain evidence fails closed.